

Erdic Philosophy & Spiritualism

Erdic culture is built upon their own sense of time and secular spirituality.

Time

Erds do not believe in “now”. Whatever that is not yet fully gone (in the past) is considered “future”. This also applies to things started in the past which still have effect.

Erdic culture is heavily bound to the contradiction of past and future intertwining - making those two concepts complementary to each other.

The Garden of Existence

Erdic spirituality revolves around the concept that is named The Garden, sometimes also The Garden of Existence or names bringing life or universe to the context.

The Garden is portrayed as three platforms of increasing width the higher they get - each level bringing different meaning to the circle of life.

While the concept itself is very abstract, it is used to guide everyday life of erdic society because “what is outside, is also inside”. Therefore it is not uncommon to refer to areas in life as “gardens”.

The Circle of Life

Waters flow from Palace, to the lakes of Garden, and down they go to the earth – filling the universe with life.

Water of the Garden, or in more theistic interpretation, Water spilled by the Gardener – is universally seen as the origin of all life. It is loosely bound to the oceans and seas around, but understood more as a symbolic than myth materialised – following the secular character of erdic vision.

The water flowing down from The Garden brings life into the universe, creating what is considered “the future”. But the time is circular, and so there’s also “the past” – everything that descended into the universe, needs to ascend back to The Garden, giving back life it was once given.

Therefore “the past” is not passive, it is active and spiritually seen as a journey forwards, not backwards. We all wander toward the past, from our future given.

Taking Care of The Garden

Despite “the past” being the ultimate destination of all beings, erdic culture is about fostering care about things that are “the future”.

The existence of the Palace (or Gardener) shows the ultimate sense of this structure – and it is *taking care of the garden*.

Thus, maintenance is one of the base principles under which erdic society operates on – and it is extrapolated in consequential order, with each level containing the previous “Garden”:

- ★ Garden is Sphere (outside of world)
- ★ Garden is World (outside of city)
- ★ Garden is City (outside of home)
- ★ Garden is Home (outside of being)
- ★ Garden is Being (outside of life waters)

The circularity of this system makes it showcase the law of mimicry – every law existing on one scope, should be applicable to another.

Taking care means that you allow something to ascend back to The Garden – therefore, erds rule out evil by simply abandoning it, as over time, nature will erase it by itself. There's a strong belief that in the sacred wheel of time, everything evil eventually will cease to exist.

This is why in Roda, the Baedoor District is not financed by the city ruler, as it reminds natives of the occupation time. Over the years, the district indeed turned into ruin and is now on the edge of becoming abandoned if not for the few residents still living there.

Tradition and Progress

The circular character of future ascending into the past makes erdic fairly traditional society, however they do not consider progress as something detrimental to the past – as long as progress maintains it, it is part of the whole.

Therefore erdic society tends to embrace progress in limited ways, filtering out what can disturb the order of The Garden, but inviting anything that does not. The definition of tradition and progress are also not necessarily existing, as they blur with each other.

***Evil**

The Care of the Garden is considered as the ultimate good that the community should strive towards – the evil, in this case, is understood as everything that disrupts said order.

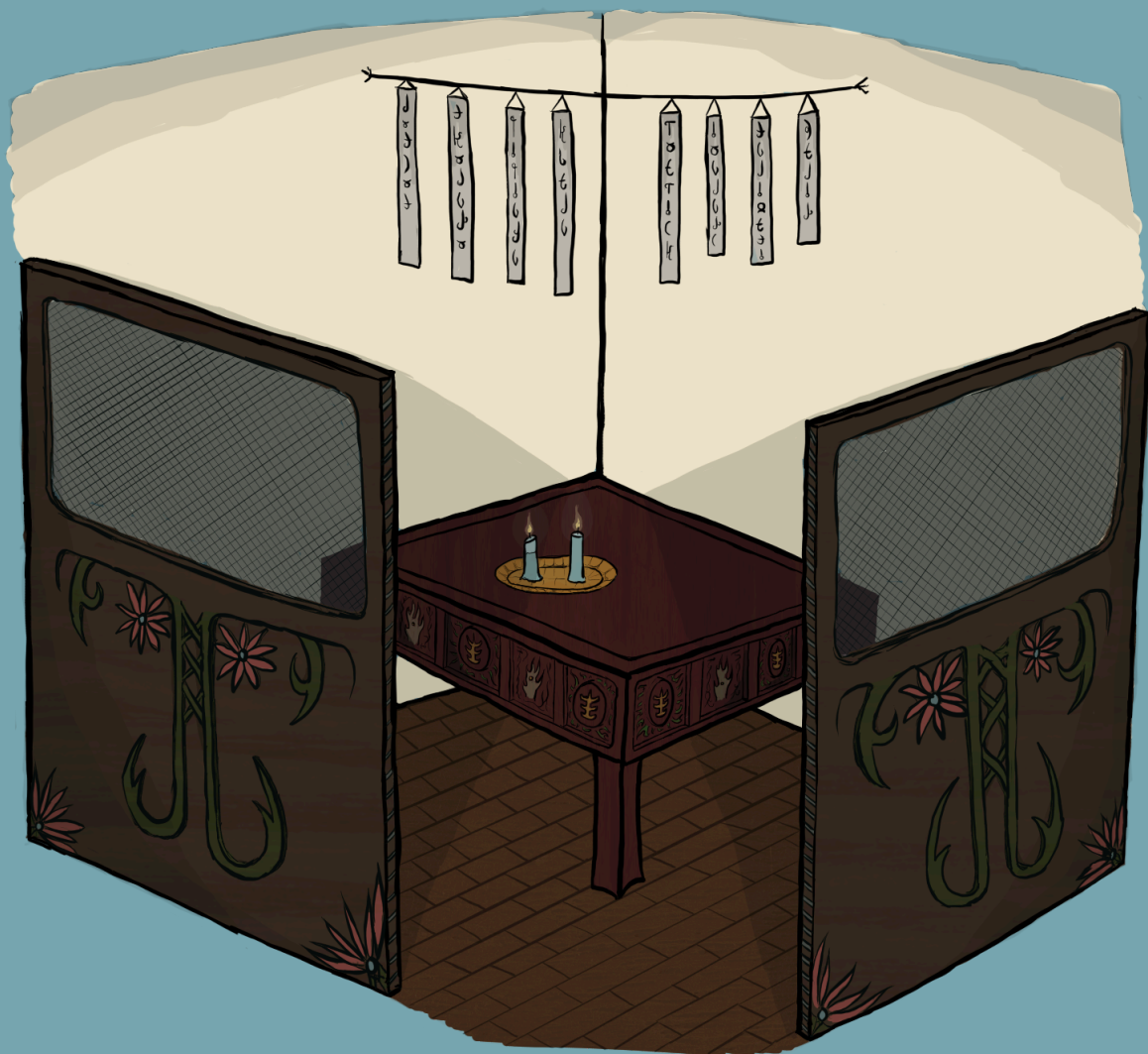
The principle of care explains a lot of how evil should be treated – the general response to it should be ignoring, if the evil is not actively trying to bring disorder to our smaller garden.

However, in situations when that happens (or when there's a possibility of that), yet another principle takes place – it is the rule of responsibility.

The Garden is not an isolated place, and neither are our “lower gardens”. Therefore, ...

***Theism**

***Care of the Dead**



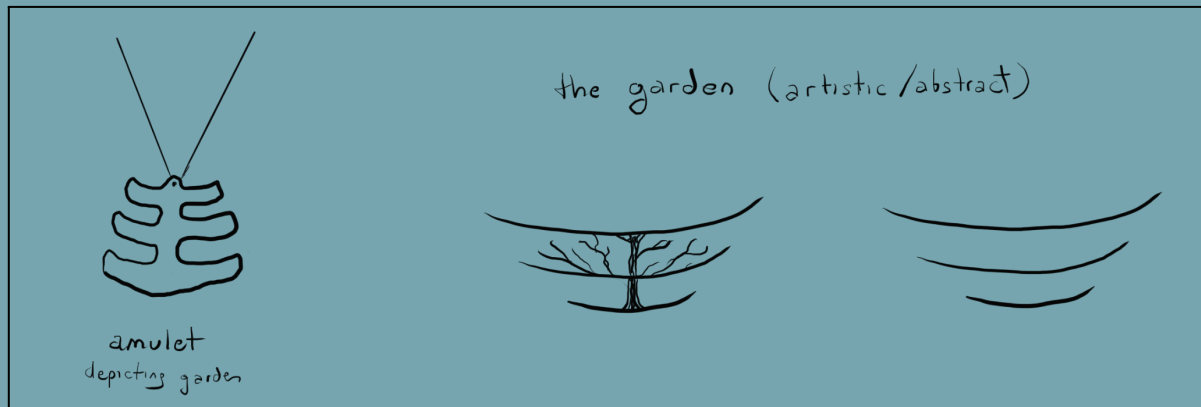




*Symbolism

Erdic concepts are often depicted in symbolic – sometimes very abstract – ways. One of the more common visual tropes is The Garden – depicted as three slightly rounded lines, portraying each level of it.

In less abstract art, erds tend to use tree branches as a common motif, adding more meaning where each level “cares” about each other – the lowest by giving birth to the tree, the middle tree by holding the top palace.



Tree and branches motif is fairly common in many places - be it tapestries, murals or decorative wares.

It is also a popular way for some sects to mark the membership - more theistic sects tend to create their own face tattoos that depict branches, as a way to publicly manifest their belief.

Some sects tend to create their own dedicated motif that is shared between all members, however a lot of individuals or less dedicated sects do not hold to specific design - it is by no means coherent.



Another symbol used by erdic philosophy and religion is circle of life - which is pretty much telling the truth of descension and ascension - the water of life descends from the future to the universe, and every being is slowly ascending towards death, giving back the life it was given.

The symbol also includes a smaller circle that showcases the

principle of mimicry - what is the law of the universe outside, is the law of the universe inside.